Standard Operating Procedure for POCAR

Event Name:

POCAR

Event Dates:

Martin Luther King Jr. Weekend (around 2nd weekend in January)

Trip Leaders:

Race Coordinator, Registration Coordinators, Volunteer Coordinator

General Itinerary

Friday 1/15/27

Volunteers leave campus, and arrive at forest to help set points for the race and setup HQ

Saturday 1/16/27

Race begins, volunteers help keep track of racers at HQ and run Fire/Water Stations on the racecourse to check in racers and provide them with warmth and water refills

Sunday 1/17/27

Volunteers help keep track of racers at HQ and run Fire/Water Stations on the racecourse to check in racers and provide them with warmth and water refills

Monday (MLK Day) 1/18/27

Race ends, volunteers help pick up points, break down HQ and Fire/Water stations, and pack out all trash. All participants return to campus

Note:

This SOP applies ONLY to volunteers. While racers participate in this event, they are not on an Outing Club trip and this SOP only applies to volunteers. If in doubt about specifics regarding the general race structure, please refer to the Race Instructions document. This can be located on the POCAR page of the Outing Club Website. If you have racer specific questions, those can be answered through the Race Rules document, which is also on the website. The EAP spells out how we mitigate any risks associated with the race.

Gear Checkout :

First Aid kits and stoves will be checked out of the closet and allocated to necessary locations by the event coordinators along with any other communal supplies. In order to check out the following gear from the sports closet the member must be able to do following:

- Tent
    - Be able to clean and use the tent properly
- Sleeping bags
    - Clean and dry after use
- Backpack
    - Clean and dry after use
- Sleeping Bag Liner
    - Clean and dry after use
- Sleeping pads
    - Properly clean and dry before returning
    - Do not puncture or destroy in any way shape or form
- Headlamp

Event Coordinators:

Before coordinating this event or being elected to the position, nominees should be proficient in the following:

- Know proper clothes and layering techniques used in winter times (no cotton, and multiple layers)
- Know how to start, maintain, and extinguish a fire with the limited resources of winter
- Know how to prevent, and treat any possible Winter Sports related injuries (or respond to them properly)
- Have knowledge of how to check and use all equipment on the trip including the first aid kit
- Know and enforce Leave no Trace principles on the trip
- Know about the area around the event and any risks or regulations of the area, and be able to communicate them to the rest of the group
- Know the emergency protocol
- Be able to provide knowledge to the group about any possible questions they have

Risk Management:

Likelihood

- Rare - almost never happens a freak event occurred
- Unlikely - Something wrong occurred when planning
- Moderate - This may or may not happen depending on how individuals prepare (if advice from consultants is ignored this will most likely happen)
- Likely - This could happen but doesn't have a high chance
- Almost Certain- this will almost always happen

Consequences

- Insignificant - Minimal injury will occur
- Minor - Some injury will occur but can be easily treated
- Moderate - Moderate injury will occur but can easily be treated
- Major - Larger lasting injury occurred, leaving the trip early is necessary
- Catastrophic - Death or other large permanent injuries

Risk Rating

- Low - low overall risk that this will occur and injure an individual on the trip
- Moderate - a moderate overall risk that this will occur and injure an individual
- High- a high overall risk that this will occur and injure an individual

All controls assume there is also a POCAR specific first aid kit on hand

Risk & Threats	**Proposed Controls**	**Likelihood (with controls)**	**Consequences (with controls)**	**Risk Rating(with controls)**
Hypothermia	Advise appropriate clothing to wear and cold weather gear to bring, come prepared to treat hypothermia	Moderate	Minor	Low
Frostbite	Advise proper methods to prevent and treat frostbite. Bring appropriate clothing/gear for the conditions	Moderate	Minor	Low
CO2 Poisoning (should propane heaters be used in HQ)	Ensure that at least 2 doors are partially open at all times. Monitor occupants for headaches, dizziness.	Unlikely	Major	Moderate
Dehydration	Advise everyone brings adequate water for trip (usually 2-3 L per day), ensure group is drinking enough	Unlikely	Minor	Low

Cuts, Bruises, minor muscle injuries, burns	Bring first aid kit, have people trained in first aid	Unlikely	Moderate	Moderate
Injuries that cannot be treated with simple first aid (require stitches, other treatment)	Have a plan - know where nearest hospital is at all times Have a form of communication, either satellite or cell phone	Rare	Major	Moderate
General sickness	Monitor people for symptoms, make sure everyone feels good before starting trip	Rare	Moderate	Low
Sunburn	Wear sunscreen	Rare	Minor	Low
Animal Encounters	Know what dangerous animals are in the trip area and use proper methods to prevent encounters	Rare	Variable	Low

Emergency Action Plan for POCAR

Event Name:

POCAR

Event Dates:

1/15/2027-1/18/2027

Trip Leader(s):

Micah Robinson - 650-709-6395
Keira Murphy - 812-340-7075
Kerby Midy - 332-279-8581

Locations

Brown County State Park

Itinerary

15 January 27, Friday

Volunteers leave campus, arrive at Maumee Scout Reservation to help set points for the race and setup HQ at Yellowwood Picnic Shelter House

16 January 27, Saturday

Race begins, volunteers help keep track of racers at HQ and run Fire/Water Stations on the racecourse to check in racers and provide them with warmth and water refills

17 January 27, Sunday

Volunteers help keep track of racers at HQ and run Fire/Water Stations on the racecourse to check in racers and provide them with warmth and water refills

18 January 27, Monday

Race ends, volunteers help pick up points, break down HQ and Fire/Water stations, and pack out all trash

Trip Contacts - Non-Emergency

Micah Robinson - Race Coordinator	(650) 709-6395	
Keira Murphy - Volunteer Coordinator	(812) 340-7075	
Kerby Midy - Registration Coordinator	(332) 279-8581	
Ellie Payne - Club President	(317) 922-9977	
Ella Shen - Club Vice President	(925) 329-1831	
Jillian Carr - Club Advisor	(281) 702-1824	

Emergency Number

9-1-1

Indiana Search and Rescue Association	(317) 426 - 1727
Brown County, IN Sheriff	(812) 988-6655
IU Health Bloomington Hospital	(812) 353 - 5252
Brown County State Park	(812) 988-6406
Club Academic Advisor - Jillian Carr	(281) 702-1824

Weather

Criteria

If any of the following criteria are met, the race will be immediately cancelled:

- A true temperature less than or equal to -25 degrees F
- A time-to-frostbite less than or equal to 10 minutes
    - The wind chill chart from the NWS is included below
- Roads impassable where any of the following are met:
    - Any park exit route becomes impassable by car
    - Any marked patrol route becomes impassable by car
    - A significant (>50%) of patrol is significantly challenging to navigate (multiple cars cannot safely pass)
    - 6 inches of new snow in a 24h period, or 8 inches in a 48h period

Predicted Cancellation
If forecasted conditions indicate a cancellation is imminent (within 24h), the Race Director can, at their discretion, issue a timed cancellation. The race is considered active until this time. The new cancellation time is to be communicated to racers at HQ (headquarters) and FW (fire water) stations. Once issued, a timed cancellation can be shortened, but cannot be extended.

Sources
The main forecast source shall be the National Weather Service Columbus / Bakalar (KBAK) prediction, extended 3 miles South of Nashville, IN (https://forecast.weather.gov/MapClick.php?lon=-86.23&lat=39.155)

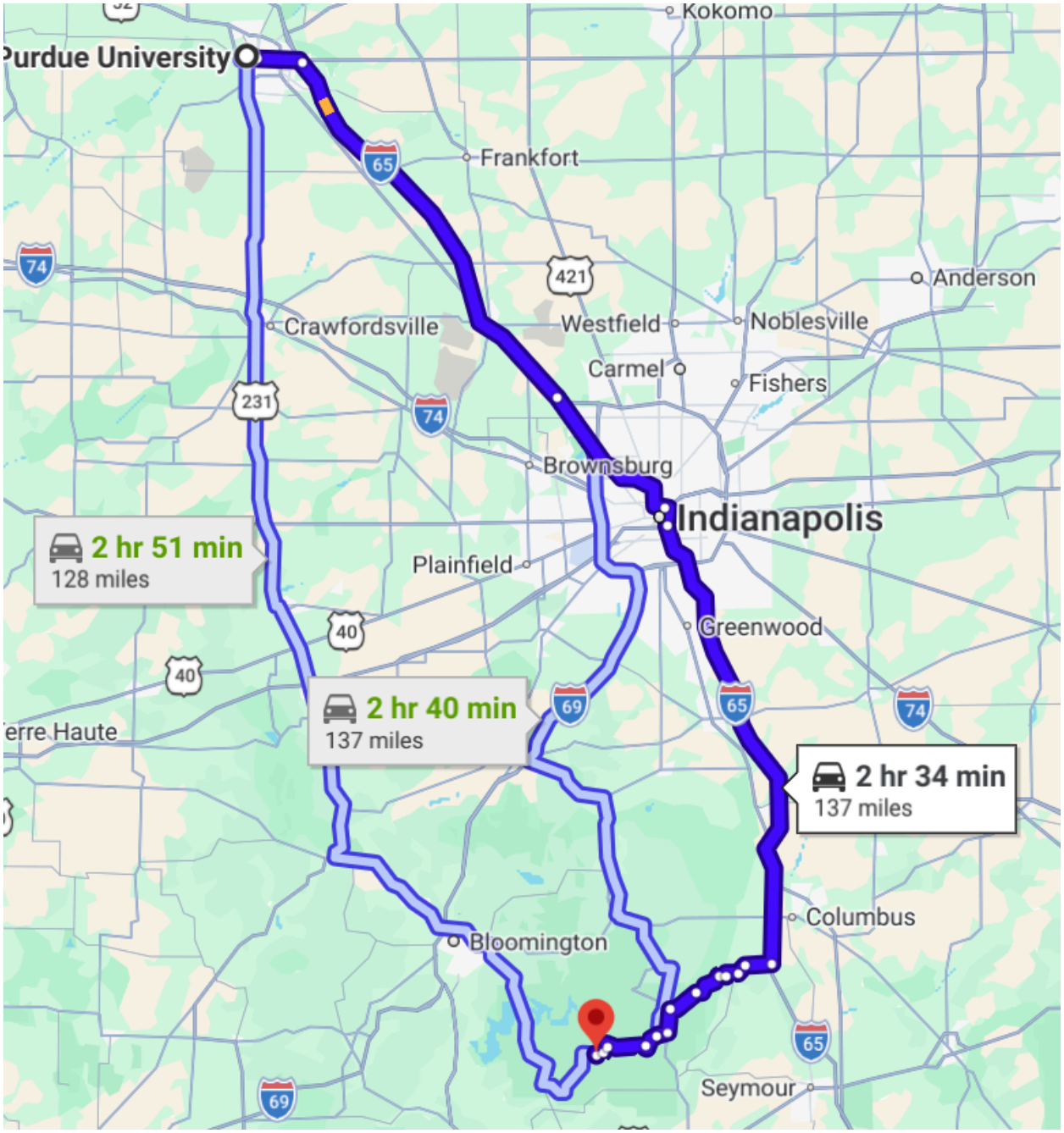
Accuweather will be used as a secondary, advisory source, using Nashville, IN, as the forecast center. (https://www.accuweather.com/en/us/nashville/46186/hourly-weather-forecast/2124072)

Weather forecasts are to be checked at least every four hours. This frequency should be increased as the weather worsens. Road conditions should be reported after each patrol.

Driving

- When driving to and from a trip location, each car must be driven by a certified driver, with a second certified driver as a passenger.
- Drivers must take one 15-minute break every 2 hours.
- Drivers are to drive the same people to and from the trip location. This will mean that the drivers are accountable for the passengers in their vehicles getting to and from their trip safely.
- All vehicles will have a copy of the Emergency Contact information and a list of the senior officers' phone numbers.

The route Volunteers will take to the event are posted below:



Note: All racers are responsible for their own travel. All volunteers will be accounted for on the driver board.

Emergency Procedures
In case of an emergency, we have a multi-step process set up to inform those who need to be informed and get the injured party help as quickly and efficiently as possible:

1. Each participant is required to have a phone or communication device, which they can use to contact the emergency contact or senior officers in case of emergency

2. Each participant and volunteer trip organizer will have the numbers of the emergency services on hand and a phone or communication device on them at all times
3. When someone is injured, an event coordinator and the consultant should immediately contact emergency services (listed on page 6), then once emergency services have been notified, notify the emergency contact.

In Case of Emergency

If an immediate, life-threatening situation has occurred, follow these procedures.

1. Designate someone to call for aid via radio. If cell service is available, call 9-1-1.
    a. Use the radio to inform the operators that they need to contact 9-1-1. They will be able to reach a location with service
    b. Make sure that radio operators update HQ about the situation
    c. Give EMS your coordinates
2. Provide immediate aid as qualified.
3. Wait for EMS.
    a. If the victim has a spinal, neck, or severe leg injury, keep the victim as warm as possible (follow hypothermia treatment protocols), but don't move the victim. Wait for EMS.
    b. If you don't have a car and the victim can be moved, radio for a car and place the victim in the car to keep them warm. Wait for EMS.

If an individual is in a life threatening situation, remember:

- Don't panic. Alert emergency services (through the radio stations, if necessary) and HQ of the situation.
- Keep the victim as warm as possible and provide first aid if qualified to do so.
- In the event that you are driving the victim somewhere, have at least three people in the car (a driver, a navigator, and someone who is qualified to look after the victim). Make sure to keep a radio, map, compass, and charged phone nearby.
- Stick to the plan once you share it with others. In the case that you must deviate from the plan, make sure everyone (EMT's, radio stations, HQ) is informed.

Fire Water Stations/ Patrolling

1. There will be three fire water stations in addition to HQ
    a. Here racers can check in, warm up by the fire, and access potable water.
    b. Each fire water station will be equipped with at least one individual with a CPR and first-aid certification and a first aid kit
        i. Headquarters will have individuals with additional training
    c. All volunteers will be going through training before the race where will review health concerns, water, radio use and the other risk reducing techniques we use at POCAR

   d. Volunteers will be on a shift schedule to ensure that they will have proper sleep. (ex. 4 hours per shift)
   e. Communication between F/W stations will be in the form of ham radio. Volunteers from the IU Ham Radio Club set up a command station near each F/W and maintain radio contact between race headquarters and the F/W stations.

1. Patrols will occur at least every other hour along designated roads in the race loops.
   a. Teams that need assistance or who want to drop out of the race should make their way to the nearest road to wait for the patrol car.

1. Check-ins
   a. Teams can check in through binders that are posted throughout the course, F/W stations and the patrol cars
   b. Racers are required to check in every 5 hours. If a team fails to check in, a search party may be sent out. If a team fails to check in for 8 hours they will be disqualified
   c. Checking in allows racers to be accounted for and volunteers to confirm that racers are in a safe condition to continue the race
   d. If the team is not wearing their visibility vests, doesn't have required gear, has less than four members, or otherwise violates the rules, volunteers will notify HQ and the team will be disqualified.
   e. If a racer is showing signs of stage 1 frostbite or is shivering uncontrollably, volunteers will consult EAP, notify HQ, and make them stay at the FW until the situation improves.
   f. F/W Stations
      i. Teams must check in with volunteers at a F/W station whenever they arrive.
      ii. Teams must check in with volunteers at a F/W station during each leg of the race. Volunteers will have a binder with sheets to record the team name and time of arrival/departure.
      iii. If a team stops at the F/W station more than once, their information will still be recorded. Teams must also check out when leaving a F/W station.
   g. Patrol Vehicles
      i. Team can check in by making contact with a patrol car
      ii. When a patrol car encounters a team along the road, the car will stop and record the name of the team, the time, where the team is going, and the approximate location they were found. At the end of each hour-long patrol, the car will relay this information to HQ.
   h. Binders
      i. There will be binders through the course that allow racers to check in if they are in a more isolated section of the course
      ii. This allows racers to confirm their status if they are far away from a F/W station
      iii. Patrol cars will check these at least every other hour to keep up to date on teams status

i. Sleep
    i. Teams are also required to inform HQ of when they plan on sleeping and starting out again. Racer campsites are near HQ, so sharing this information won't be too inconvenient. This prevents race coordinators from believing the team as lost when they are just sleeping in a car or a tent.

Accounting for Missing Teams

If a team has not been encountered for 8 hours and is not sleeping, measures will begin to be taken to locate the team. First, using the complete data from the event, the last place the team was seen by patrol, F/W station, or HQ will be determined, as well as their intended target upon leaving. If possible, patrols will be extended past the usual route into that area. All other teams will be informed to keep a look out for the uncontacted team and instruct them to make contact with race officials immediately.

At 12 hours the team is declared missing. A race official will call 9-1-1 and activate county EMS/SAR services. All available volunteers will be sent out in groups of four on designated search routes carrying first aid and shelter/heat solutions. They will thoroughly patrol the route and report back as quickly as possible.

Required Safety Equipment teams must have at all times

These will be checked before the beginning of the race as well as randomly throughout the race. These are the minimal requirements, however, additional equipment is recommended.

Per Team

- 1 sleeping bag+1 emergency blanket or 2 sleeping bags
- Maps (provided)
- Compass
- A watch
- A whistle
- Race vests (provided)
- Shelter - tarp, tent or equivalent that all team members can fit under/in
  Note: bivy sacks may count as a sleeping bag and shelter for a person, but do not count as the shelter for the whole team, as only one person can fit in it.
- Water filter or iodine tablets
- First aid kit- needs a minimum of:
    - 1 ACE bandage
    - 2 adhesive bandages
    - 2 3x3 gauze (or Teflon) pads
    - 1 antiseptic tube
    - 10 tablets aspirin, ibuprofen, naproxen, or acetaminophen, as a minimum

  These are the minimum requirements for a first aid kit. Additional supplies are recommended.

Per Racer:

- Rain Jacket
- Headlamp or Flashlight (with spare batteries)
- 2 Liters of Water
- Hat/Gloves/Warm Clothing

Health Concerns

All volunteers will be going through training before the race where will review health concerns, water, radio use and the other risk reducing techniques we use at POCAR

1. Frostbite (information retrieved from the Mayo Clinic website)
   There are three stages of frostbite.
   Stage 1- Frostnip
   Skin is cold, turns red, and may appear pale. Prickling and numbness may occur. Rewarming the affected skin might cause a tingling sensation. Many experience this stage if outside for long lengths of time in cold weather (winter).
   Stage 2- Superficial frostbite
   Red skin turns pale/white. Ice crystals might form on the skin at this stage. Rewarming the affected area may cause a mottled, blue, or purple appearance and stinging or swelling can occur. Seek medical treatment by a professional at this stage of frostbite.
   Stage 3- Severe frostbite
   All skin layers affected. Numbness and loss of sensation, including pain for the affected area. Joints and muscles may cease to work. Rewarming the affected area can cause blisters and the skin will become black due to tissue death. Seek medical treatment by a professional immediately as this is a life threatening condition.
   The best way to prevent frostbite is to catch it in the initial stages (stage 1). Get out of the cold/wind. Re-warm the affected areas slowly by starting at the extremities and working inward (fingers to hands, toes to feet, nose to cheeks). This can be done by tucking fingers and toes into warm clothing to be warmed by body heat. Do not rub affected areas as this may damage the skin further.

2. Hypothermia (information retrieved from the Mayo Clinic website)
   A condition in which the body temperature drops below 95°F. It can become life threatening if not treated early.

   Symptoms:
   - Uncontrollable shivering
   - No shivering- this happens at low body temperatures
   - Slurred speech
   - Clumsiness
   - Confusion

- Drowsiness
- Loss of consciousness

Treatment:

Move individuals out of the cold. Remove wet clothes and replace them with dry clothes and/or blankets. Warm the individual slowly. There are fires at all three F/W stations as well as headquarters- place the individual near a fire (not right in front of one). Warm water bottles as well as hand warmers can be placed near the neck, armpits, chest, and groin of the individual to warm them. Do **NOT** rub the individual's arms or legs to warm them as it can stress the heart and lungs.

3. Sleep deprivation

   This is a problem for both racers and volunteers. Extreme sleep deprivation can have far reaching negative consequences. Cognitive ability decreases as well as the ability to concentrate, which during an adventure race in the middle of winter is dangerous. Signs of sleep deprivation can include: decrease in ability to concentrate, sluggishness, irritability, irrationality, hallucinations, micro sleeps. If someone is sleep deprived, the best thing to do is to have them get some sleep.

Water

F/W stations and headquarters will have water jugs for participants and volunteers to use. There is a water source at the ranger station where the jugs will be refilled. Contact race headquarters by radio to notify patrols that the jug is low (don't wait until it is completely empty) on water and another will be brought during the next patrol. Hydration is essential during the race, especially since the weather is cold. Teammates need to look out for each other to prevent dehydration.